

PHYSICS 1101W.200 Syllabus

Introductory College Physics I, Fall 2026

Welcome

Physics 1101 is the first semester of a two-semester introduction to physics. The primary emphasis of this semester will be on human scale physics and developing an organized problem-solving framework to use that physics. We will study the interaction of familiar objects based on a small number of principles that apply at all scales, from subatomic to galactic. We begin with the understanding that everyone in the class already has their own theory of physics built from their own experiences. Most of this personal theory is correct but may not be optimally organized. This course is designed to help you renovate, reorganize, and simplify that theory. As with all human thought, there are parts of your personal theory that are inconsistent, incomplete, or incorrect. The course will help you identify and mitigate some of these difficulties. We will start this process by analyzing how familiar objects interact with each other and describe those interactions as forces. We will also describe what happens to the objects after they interact using the ideas of conservation of both momentum and energy. We will use these basic principles of physics to determine in detail how interactions effect how objects move. By the end of this semester, you should develop a more organized understanding and awareness of the phenomena occurring in your everyday environment. Our goal is that the simple models presented in this course will help you understand the behavior of the more complex systems you wish to study such as biology, human performance, technology, the environment, or mechanical structures.

Instructors & Office Hours

Professor: **Ken Heller**, office: PAN 348, web page <https://cse.umn.edu/physics/kenneth-heller>

Email: heller@umn.edu

Office hours: TBD in 348 PAN (Physics & Nanotechnology Building) or by appointment

Teaching Assistants:

disc	sect	lab	TA	email
202	203		Sage Buesing	< lehrm022@umn.edu >
204	205		Shiyu Guo	< grime170@umn.edu >
206	207		Olivia Chabowski	< chabo026@umn.edu >
208	209		Sage Buesing	< lehrm022@umn.edu >
210	211		Olivia Chabowski	< chabo026@umn.edu >

TA office hours TBD in Tate Hall B25.

Email (Write 'Physics 1101' in the subject line)

Your TA's email or heller@umn.edu

Class time and place

Lectures: T,Th 17:45-19:00, Tate Hall B20

First lecture Tuesday September 8th, last lecture Tuesday December 16th.

Discussion sections: See your schedule: First discussion Tue. Sept. 8, last Tue. Dec. 16.

Labs: Tate B76. See your schedule for the time, First lab Tue. Sept. 8, last Wed. Dec 17.

Group Quizzes: In discussion section. Sept. 29, Oct. 27, Dec. 1

Individual Quizzes: During lecture time, rooms TBD. Oct. 1, Oct. 29, Dec. 3

Final exam: Rooms TBD. Saturday Dec. 19, 18:30 - 21:30

Preparation

Before each lecture:

- Readings: a first reading of the textbook chapter sections listed in the syllabus is the background for the lecture.
- Answer the pre-lecture questions on Canvas.
- Bring an internet device (phone, pad, or laptop) to access ChimeIn on Canvas.

Before each lab:

- Read the information on your lab Canvas website to prepare for each session.
- Answer the warm-up and prediction questions on Canvas. You cannot attend your lab session if you have not submitted the warm-ups and prediction.
- Bring your lab notebook.
- Lab reports will be due about every four weeks. Your TA will assign them.

On-going:

- Keep up with the suggested homework.

If you have questions about homework problems or sample quizzes, please visit the tutoring room Tate B25. Don't wait until just before a quiz. In addition to the tutoring room, there are peer-tutors available to help you for Phys1101 through the Walter Smart Learning Commons on a drop-in basis: <https://tasc.umn.edu/tutoring-services>

Class Webpages

- Go to MyU to access Canvas, PHYS 1101W (100). The lecture notes will be posted just after the class. Refer to the class notes on the Canvas page for official announcements regarding the course. Solutions to quizzes and suggested homework will be posted on the Canvas page.
- Go to MyU to access Canvas, PHYS 1101W (your lab section). This is where the instruction for each week's lab will be posted and where you will submit your lab assignments and technical reports.

Course materials

Textbook: *College Physics 2e*; by Urone & Hinrichs, revised for this class and posted on Canvas. The original version is available at <https://openstax.org/details/books/college-physics-2e>.

Internet device: a phone, pad, or laptop that connects to the internet with a math app and the Canvas app.

Lab Notebook: Univ. of Minnesota 2077-S

- **A device you bring to lab that connects to the internet and takes video:** your phone, tablet, or laptop.

TA office hours

Our TA office hours will be included on the Canvas office hour link. These will be held in Tate Hall B25. Tate Hall B25 is staffed by Physics TAs at most times between 8am and 5pm M-F. The times for 1101 TAs are listed on the Canvas class site. Any TA, whether they are assigned to our course or not, is available for you to consult.

Faculty office hours

Faculty office hours are listed on the Canvas class site. These will be held in PAN 348. Additional office hour appointments are available by email request.

Prerequisites

All your experience is relevant since you build ideas based on that knowledge. Because the essence of science is that its claims are testable, we will use mathematics to make specific predictions. To do that, being comfortable with the basic ideas in algebra, geometry, and trigonometry is essential.

- During quizzes, you can use any calculator if it does not connect to the internet. Note that phones, tablets, and laptops will not be permitted during quizzes or exams.

Workload

Since each new topic builds on previous work, it is important not fall behind. Plan for a workload consistent with the University policy (three hours each week per credit for an average student to receive a passing grade). This amounts to most people spending at least six hours every week working on physics outside of scheduled class meetings to get a C, a higher grade usually requires more time.

The lecture

The ideas and techniques of science are motivated by the human desire to solve problems. In lecture we will motivate and introduce new material to solve problems based on experience and observation. We will also show how to apply a general problem-solving framework to specific physics examples. The purpose of the lecture, labs, and discussion section is to give you the opportunity to connect physics to your existing ideas and skills. We will utilize a variety of tools and devices to assist you in making these connections. **Lecture demonstrations** so you can predict how objects behave and then observe if their behavior aligns with your own thought processes. **In-class questions (ICQ)** will occur during lectures using ChimeIn via the Canvas course website to help you diagnose your own thinking about physics concepts. During lecture, discussion sections, and lab you will discuss and practice using an organized problem-solving framework with other students to help you clarify your own thinking. The lectures are complimentary to the text and do not present the same material in the same way. The lectures should give you a slightly different point of view than the text, sometime giving more detail and sometimes less. Where the text seems adequate, we will assume that you don't need a lecture on that topic. To get the benefit of the lecture it is important to complete assigned reading at least once over lightly before attending class. That way in lecture you can focus your attention on ideas you found confusing.

Discussion Sessions

In discussion sessions you work with a small group to solve a challenging problem. A full solution to the problem will be available on Canvas by the next day. On quiz week, there will be a group problem in the discussion session, which will count as one of the three problems on that quiz. Your group will solve that problem collaboratively with all group members receiving the same score for that problem. All groups are assigned by the TA with new groups assigned after each quiz.

Laboratories

You will have the same TA and work in the same group as in your discussion session. The physics problems addressed by the labs are coordinated with lectures, usually within the same week as the lecture material. The labs are designed to give you an opportunity to test, discuss, expand, and

refine your understanding of the physics and problem-solving concepts. Careful recording of observations in your lab notebook and preparation of written technical reports are important parts of this experience. You will be assigned to write 3 such technical reports (lab reports) during the semester. Lab exercises are carried out in a group and the equipment for each lab is available for only a limited time. That means that it is important to make good notes about what you did, why you did it, your measurements, and your results in your lab notebook. Remember, you may have to write a technical report a month after you have completed that lab. Each member of your group will write a technical report on a different lab.

Because this course satisfies University requirements as a laboratory science class and as a writing intensive course, **you must receive a minimum laboratory grade of 60% to receive a passing grade in the course.** The laboratory grade will be based on the demonstration of a well-organized and **correct** written technical communication of the physics concepts of this course in your laboratory notebook and technical reports as well as well thought out answers to the warm-up and prediction questions, that do not necessarily need to be correct, each week. At the end of each lab period, your TA will check that you have recorded the appropriate data and analysis in your lab notebook as part of your lab grade and that you have submitted a conclusion about that lab by the time assigned. Part of your lab grade will also include your TA's assessment of your collaborative skills as evidenced by effective group work. **There are no make-up laboratories**, except in unavoidable circumstances. In that case, the laboratory work must be made up by arrangement with your TA before your next scheduled laboratory period. **Grades for laboratory work will be determined by:**

- **Three technical reports.** Reports should be no longer than 8 nor shorter than 4 typed pages using a word processor and submitted as a pdf file that includes all necessary descriptions, graphs, data tables, and calculations. Reports must be delivered electronically to your laboratory instructor through Canvas for grading by the assigned deadline. Late reports will not be accepted. Graded reports will be returned to you not later one week after all the reports for that lab section are turned in. Your first report may be revised based on TA feedback to achieve a higher grade. The revised report must be given to your laboratory instructor **no more than 1 week** after you receive the feedback. Details of the laboratory grading will be given by your TA. Remember this is a writing intensive course so your lab grade will depend on your communication skills as well as your physics knowledge. The specific laboratory problem for which you will write a technical report is assigned to you by your TA at about four-week intervals.

- **Canvas assignments including the warm-up and prediction questions, the data and analysis check and the conclusion.** The warm-up and prediction questions must be turned in on Canvas the day before each lab session. Before leaving a lab session, your TA will check your lab notebook for the data and its analysis. Your preliminary lab conclusion, also a picture of your lab notebook, must be uploaded to Canvas by the deadline assigned by your TA.

Missing discussion and laboratory sessions with no valid excuse

The rule for discussion section is that if you don't practice with the team, you can't play with the team. In other words, if you miss a discussion session, you will not be allowed to take the group part of the next quiz. If you have an unavoidable reason for missing a discussion section and you have informed the other members of your group, check with the TA to see if an exception can be made. If you miss a lab session, you will not get the credit for that lab. If you miss more than one lab session without an unavoidable reason accepted as such by your TA, the score of your next lab report will be zero.

Reading and Problem Assignments

The only way you can determine if you have experienced meaningful learning is to use newly acquired knowledge to solve problems. The human brain is built to be good at solving problems, but practice is necessary to build the required neural links. The purpose of science, including physics, is to solve problems in a quantitative way. To be good at problem-solving you need to practice answering two types of questions. One type consists of those you know how to answer, called exercises. Repeatedly answering exercises strengthens your skills so that they are ready to apply to problems. The other type of question is problems. By definition, a problem is a question that when you first look at it, your reaction is that you don't know what to do. To learn how to solve problems you need to practice solving problems. To gain anything from this practice, you must try your best to answer either type of question without looking at someone else's solution or asking an AI. As the first step while you are reading the textbook, practice solving the examples given yourself before you read the authors' solutions. After you have tried your best, whether you reach a solution or not, look at the solution and determine how it deviates from the way you tried to solve it. There are many ways of solving a physics problem and the solution of the author may not be the best for you. Working problems at the end of a chapter is the only reliable way to test your understanding of a topic. Some of these end-of-chapter questions that are called problems, may be exercises for you. Start out by trying some you think are exercises. After you have done several exercises successfully, select some you think will be problems for you and try them. After you have answered them, see if your answer agrees other students in the class. If not, or if you can't come up with any answer, seek help from your fellow students or the class instructional team. Once you have gotten help or looked at the solution outline, you need to try some related problems to see if you have really learned how to do it. A sample quiz will be posted on Canvas the week before each quiz. The quiz problems will be of the same type and general level of difficulty as those whose solutions are presented in lecture, or those worked on by your group in discussion session and lab.

Solving problems requires having an organized framework. We will demonstrate such a framework when presenting problem solutions in the lecture and written solutions for discussion problems and quizzes.

Quizzes and Final Exam

There will be three quizzes, each in two parts. The first part of each quiz is a group quiz during the discussion session (50 min) on a **Tuesday**. The second part is a 75 min individual quiz during the following **Thursday's** lecture time. The group part of the quiz consists of one problem. The individual part will be two problems and about 10 multiple choice questions. The 3-hour final exam will be an individual test with about 5 problems and about 15 multiple choice questions. Throughout the course we will build a small collection of important equations that will be given to you on each quiz and the final exam. To make sure you do not get caught up in equation memorization, these will be the only equations, apart from common knowledge, allowed for solving problems on tests. On the quizzes and the final exam, laptops, tablet computers, and phones will not be permitted. No early, late, or make-up quizzes will be given. However, any number of quizzes will be dropped from the course grade if they are below the final exam grade (see below).

Course grade: The course grade will be determined by combining the grades from the various components of the course in the following way. Each component has a maximum value of 100 points.

- Each of the 3 quizzes count as 17% (any quizzes lower than your final will be replaced by the final exam score).
- The final counts as 17% of your grade if no quiz is dropped, 34% if one quiz is dropped, 51% if two are dropped, 68% if three are dropped.
- The laboratory counts as 20%.
- Correct in-lecture questions count as 6%.
- Answers to pre-lecture questions count as 6%.

All grades are on a scale of 0-100. The final letter grade for the course will then be assigned as follows:

A : greater than or equal to 90	B+: less than 85 and greater than or equal to 80	C+: less than 70 and greater than or equal to 65	D+ : less than 55 and greater than or equal to 50
A-: less than 90 and greater than or equal to 85	B : less than 80 and greater than or equal to 75	C : less than 65 and greater than or equal to 60	D : less than 50 and greater than or equal to 45
	B-: less than 75 and greater than or equal to 70	C- : less than 60 and greater than or equal to 55	F : less than 45 or a laboratory grade less than 60.

Example of grade calculation: Using this example you can always calculate the score you need on any component of the course to get the grade you want.

Consider the set of grades: 86, 55, 90 (quizzes); 79 (final); 87 (laboratory); 80 (pre-lecture), and 75 (in-class). Because it is lower than the final exam score, the quiz with score of 55 will be replaced by the final exam score.

The total numerical score is then:

$(86+90)(0.17)+(79)(0.34)+(87)(0.20)+(80)(0.06)+(75)(0.06) = 83.48$, yielding a grade of B+.

Suppose the scores for the final and the second quiz were exchanged, so that the score on the final was 55.

Then the total numerical score would be:

$(86+79+90)(.17)+(55)(0.17)+(87)(0.20)+(80)(0.06)+(75)(0.06) = 79.4$, yielding a grade of B.

The official University definitions of grades

A: achievement that is outstanding relative to the level necessary to meet course requirements.

B: achievement that is significantly above the level necessary to meet course requirements.

C: achievement that meets the course requirements in every respect.

D: achievement that is worthy of credit even though it fails to meet fully the course requirements.

F: represents failure (or no credit) and signifies that the work was either (1) completed but at a level of achievement that is not worthy of credit or (2) was not completed.

What do grades mean in this class?

A: You can communicate a good working knowledge of physics, mathematics, and logic. You occasionally make some minor mistakes but no major physics, logic, or mathematical errors. You can feel confident in applying physics. You should offer physics help to others when necessary but don't assume your way of understanding will be theirs. It is always a good idea to have someone go over your physics reasoning before applying it to any situation that has consequences since no one is perfect.

B: You communicate an adequate working knowledge of physics, math, and logic. You make an occasional major physics error and some minor mistakes in physics, logic, or mathematics. You can offer physics advice to others when necessary. Always have someone carefully check your physics and reasoning before applying it to a situation that has consequences.

C: You communicate a familiarity with physics, math, and logic. You can recognize which major concepts apply to a situation. You give a reasonable interpretation of how a problem is related to physics and make a good but sometimes incomplete attempt at constructing a logical solution. You tend to make several major physics errors together with other minor mistakes. You know when to apply your physics knowledge and generally how to go about it but will need to get help before you use physics, mathematics, or logic in any situation that has consequences.

D: You communicate that you have attended the physics class and read the text. You often do not interpret problems in a complete manner and often cannot connect a specific problem to useful physics concepts. You do not communicate that you can construct a logical problem solution. You tend to make many major physics errors, have missing and erroneous concepts, and make other major mistakes in both logic and mathematics. Do not attempt to use physics, mathematics, or logic in any situation that has consequences.

F: Your work shows no evidence of having taken this physics course or you did not satisfactorily complete the laboratory for this class.

Getting help

Getting assistance from the internet to give you individual coaching for the concepts and mathematics in the course can be very helpful. However, every internet tool that you use requires that you translate your specific needs into a language that is understood by others (either people or computers) that do not know the context of your class. This translation process can be very helpful to you to you gaining your own understanding of the material. It can also seem like a lot of extra work unless you already understand most of what you need to do.

Artificial intelligence (AI) large language models, such as Gemini can be useful in helping to coach you to solve physics problems. However, they must be carefully and iteratively guided to give you the help appropriate for this course. If you are stuck at some stage of solving a problem, you should instruct the AI to not give you the solution to the problem but give you questions to help you determine what you don't understand. AI's also make mistakes and outright false statements, called "hallucinating". Evaluating an AI's response and correcting it is good practice for evaluating your own work.

Other useful help for this course is available online from YouTube videos (Khan Academy or others) or chat rooms. The downside is that these often build from a different point of view and use different notation from your course. Without a proper understanding of the emphasis of your class,

and the making the translation to their online presentations, it can seem as if you are trying to learn two different courses. That said, looking at some material from different viewpoints can be beneficial to building your own understanding.

Using an online mathematics calculator such as Wolfram Alpha or an AI can be very helpful in solving a complex set of equations that you develop to solve a problem. However, it is useful to be able to do the calculations by yourself to determine if the computer is incorrect. You will also need to be able to translate the mathematical symbols that are easiest for you to understand to a notation that the computer can understand.

If you use an AI to generate work for a course assignment you must write the contribution of that AI for the work that it has done. Copying from an AI is the same as copying from a person and is plagiarism unless it is explicitly acknowledged.

- Any work submitted as a course assignment must be substantially your own;
- Submitting your work for this class to an online learning support platform for iteration or improvement is allowed but the contributions of that support platform must be explicitly acknowledged as not your own. Because AI's collect knowledge about you and the way you think, you should only use University approved AI's that will not record your information outside of the University. At the present time, only Gemini accessed from the University AI web page is approved to protect your privacy. The University is currently negotiating with other AI companies to institute this privacy control. If you are in doubt as to whether you are using an online learning support platform appropriately in this course, I encourage you to discuss your situation with me or your TA.

Any assignment content composed by any resource other than you, regardless of whether that resource is human or digital, must be attributed to the source through proper citation. Unattributed use of online learning support platforms and unauthorized sharing of instructional property are forms of scholastic dishonesty and will be treated as such.

Tentative Plan

Week	Topic	Chapter(s)
1 - 2	Course organization & expectations. Learning, Problem Solving, Objects, Systems, Interactions, and Conservation	
2 – 3	Forces, vectors, & problem solving	
3 – 4	Forces	
4	Quiz 1 (group Tu, individual Th)	
5 - 6	Forces, Torque & Structures	
6 - 7	Motion, Interactions, & conservation of energy	

8	Quiz 2	
9 - 10	Conservation of energy, Internal Energy, Potential energy	
11 - 12	Conservation of momentum & motion	
12	Conservation of momentum & conservation of energy, Thanksgiving	
13	Quiz 3	
13-15	Forces, energy, momentum, motion & circular motion	
15	Review, Final Exam	

Other information

Minnesota privacy laws require that tests and other materials are returned in a manner that ensures that no one else can see your grades.

Liberal Education Requirement

The class emphasizes physical principles and concepts, demonstrates how these principles can be applied to quantitatively describe natural phenomena, and provides an opportunity to perform hands-on measurements that model how physical knowledge is obtained. Familiarity with the methods and findings of the physical sciences not only forms a crucial component of a common education, but also prepares students to be scientifically literate citizens.

Because all knowledge in the physical sciences is empirically acquired, the laboratory component of the course is essential to understanding the scientific method and the ways of knowing and thinking in the physical sciences. Physics, like all sciences, is a social endeavor, and students experience cooperative problem solving, working in small groups with other students, in both the laboratory and discussion sections of the course.

Policies

Illness Policies

Out of respect to your classmates, you should not come to class if you have any type of illness that might be contagious. With illness, sharing is not a virtue.

Departmental Policies

Athletes must provide their official University of Minnesota athletic letter containing the approved competition schedule to their instructor and to the physics front office (physics@umn.edu). Away exams may be arranged with athletic advising if appropriate staff are traveling with the team. Accommodations will be made for official university sports only (i.e. no accommodations will be

made for intramurals, club sports, etc.)

Disability Services: If you have accommodations for this course, make sure you email a copy of your DRC accommodation letter to your faculty instructor and copy the physics front office at physics@umn.edu. Testing accommodations will be provided at the Disability Resource Center. If you have testing accommodations, please schedule your tests at least one week in advance through the DRC portal at <https://disability.umn.edu/accommodations/accessible-information-management-aim>

University Policies

Make-up work policy for missed assignments

This course follows the university policy for make-up work due to legitimate absences <https://policy.umn.edu/education/makeupwork>. Students will not be penalized for absence or missed assignments during the semester due to unavoidable or legitimate circumstances outlined in the policy, which include verified illness, participation in intercollegiate athletic events, subpoenas, jury duty, military service, bereavement, and religious observances. Such circumstances do not include voting in local, state, or national elections. Please check the policy for a complete list. For circumstances not listed in the University policy, the instructor has primary responsibility to decide on a case-by-case basis if an absence is due to unavoidable or legitimate circumstances. If you need to miss an assignment, including quizzes, due to a legitimate circumstance please contact your instructor in a timely manner. Your instructor will discuss the nature of the accommodation or make-up work with you. If you need to miss the final exam due to a university recognized reason, you will take a make-up final exam. Instructions on how to request a make-up final will be distributed later.

Student conduct code

The University seeks an environment that promotes academic achievement and integrity, that is protective of free inquiry, and that serves the educational mission of the University. To support this environment, the University seeks a community that is free from violence, threats, and intimidation; that is respectful of the rights, opportunities, and welfare of students, faculty, staff, and guests of the University; and that does not threaten the physical or mental health or safety of members of the University community.

As a student at the University you are expected to adhere to the Board of Regents Policy: [Student Conduct Code](#). Note that the conduct code specifically addresses disruptive classroom conduct, which means “engaging in behavior that substantially or repeatedly interrupts either the instructor's ability to teach and/or a student’s ability to learn.” The classroom extends to any setting where a student is engaged in work toward academic credit or satisfaction of program-based requirements or related activities.

Scholastic Dishonesty

You are expected to do your own academic work and cite sources as necessary. Failing to do so is scholastic dishonesty. Scholastic dishonesty means: plagiarizing; cheating on assignments or examinations, including the unauthorized use of online learning support and testing platforms; engaging in unauthorized collaboration on academic work; taking, acquiring, or using test materials without faculty permission; submitting false or incomplete records of academic achievement; acting alone or in cooperation with another to falsify records or to obtain dishonestly grades, honors, awards, or professional endorsement; altering, forging, misrepresenting, or misusing a

University academic record; or fabricating or falsifying data, research procedures, or data analysis. If it is determined that a student has cheated, the student may be given an “F” or an “N” for the course, and may face additional sanctions from the University. For additional information, please see: Teaching and Learning: [Instructor and Unit Responsibility](#).

The Office for [Community Standards](#) has compiled a useful list of Frequently Asked Questions pertaining to scholastic dishonesty.

Beware of websites that advertise themselves as being “tutoring websites.” It is not permissible to upload any instructor materials to these sites without their permission or copy material for your own homework assignments from these various sites. If you have additional questions and concerns, please clarify with your instructor for the course. Your instructor can respond to your specific questions regarding what would constitute scholastic dishonesty in the context of a particular class, e.g., when and whether collaboration on assignments is permitted, requirements and methods for citing sources, if electronic aids are permitted or prohibited during an exam.

Appropriate Student Use of Class Notes and Course Materials

Taking notes is a means of recording information but more importantly of personally absorbing and integrating the educational experience. However, broadly disseminating class notes beyond the classroom community or accepting compensation for taking and distributing classroom notes undermines instructor interests in their intellectual work product while not substantially furthering instructor and student interests in effective learning. Such actions violate shared norms and standards of the academic community. For additional information, please see Administrative Policy: Teaching and Learning: Student Responsibilities.

University Grading Scale

Please see: <http://policy.umn.edu/education/gradingtranscripts>

Sexual harassment, sexual assault, stalking and relationship violence

The University prohibits sexual misconduct, and encourages anyone experiencing sexual misconduct to access resources for personal support and reporting. If you want to speak confidentially with someone about an experience of sexual misconduct, please contact a [confidential resource](#) on your campus. If you want to report sexual misconduct, or have questions about the University’s policies and procedures related to sexual misconduct, please contact your campus [Title IX office](#) or relevant policy contacts.

Instructors are required to share information they learn about possible sexual misconduct with the campus Title IX office that addresses these concerns. This allows a Title IX staff member to reach out to those who have experienced sexual misconduct to provide information about personal support resources and options for investigation. You may talk to instructors about concerns related to sexual misconduct, and they will provide support and keep the information you share private to the extent possible given their University role.

For more information, please see Administrative Policy: [Sexual Harassment, Sexual Assault, Stalking and Relationship Violence](#).

Equity, Diversity, Equal Opportunity, and Affirmative Action

The University provides equal access to and opportunity in its programs and facilities, without regard to race, color, creed, religion, national origin, gender, age, marital status, familial status,

disability, public assistance status, membership or activity in a local commission created for the purpose of dealing with discrimination, veteran status, sexual orientation, gender identity, or gender expression. For more information, please consult Board of Regents Policy: [Equity, Diversity, Equal Opportunity, and Affirmative Action](#) (PDF).

Disability Accommodations

The University of Minnesota is committed to creating learning environments that are inclusive and accessible to all students. If you are experiencing disability-related barriers to learning in your courses, the Disability Resource Center (DRC) is the office that collaborates with students to explore reasonable accommodations, tools, and resources.

- If you are registered with the DRC and have a current accommodation letter please share your letter with me, as well as with our front office (physics@umn.edu) as soon as possible so that we can discuss how your accommodations will be implemented in this course. The sooner I know about your disability access-needs, the more equipped I can be to facilitate accommodations. You may reach out to me or your (access consultant/disability specialist) if you have any questions or concerns about your accommodations.
 - If you are not registered with the DRC and are experiencing or think you may be experiencing disability related to a mental health, attention, learning, chronic health, sensory, or physical condition, and would like to discuss accommodations and/or resources, please contact the DRC (information below).
 - If you have a short-term medical condition, such as a broken arm, I may be able to assist in minimizing classroom barriers. In situations where additional assistance is needed, you should contact the DRC as noted above.
- For more information, please visit <https://disability.umn.edu/> and/or contact drc@umn.edu or (612) 626-1333.

Mental Health and Stress Management

As a student you may experience a range of issues that can cause barriers to learning, such as strained relationships, increased anxiety, alcohol/drug problems, feeling down, difficulty concentrating and/or lack of motivation. These mental health concerns or stressful events may lead to diminished academic performance and may reduce your ability to participate in daily activities. University services are available to assist you. You can learn more about the broad range of confidential mental health services available on campus via the [Student Mental Health](#) website.

Academic Freedom and Responsibility

Academic freedom is a cornerstone of the University. Within the scope and content of the course as defined by the instructor, it includes the freedom to discuss relevant matters in the classroom. Along with this freedom comes responsibility. Students are encouraged to develop the capacity for critical judgment and to engage in a sustained and independent search for truth. Students are free to take reasoned exception to the views offered in any course of study and to reserve judgment about matters of opinion, but they are responsible for learning the content of any course of study for which they are enrolled.*

Reports of concerns about academic freedom are taken seriously, and there are individuals and

offices available for help. Contact the instructor, the Department Chair, your adviser, the associate dean of the college, or the Vice Provost for Faculty and Academic Affairs in the Office of the Provost.

* Language adapted from the American Association of University Professors “Joint Statement on Rights and Freedoms of Students.”